



Boot Guard bypass

Security researchers have discovered that poor firmware implementation can lead to the bypass of Intel Boot Guard. <http://dgit.in/BcBypas>



Google is now going after AI ships

The tech giant is leveraging its capabilities in machine intelligence to help Rolls-Royce build autonomous ships. <http://dgit.in/ShipAI>

FOR THE PROVIDERS

Amid all of this, the service providers stand to gain beyond monetary compensation as well. For instance, Cheep provides insurance to service providers for any damage or harm incurred during service delivery. Although, they do have to forego the same if they chose to take on work beyond Cheep assignments as well - which is something that they aren't explicitly forbidden from doing.

company presents a more unified front in terms of service quality and pricing. On the other hand, this often ends up in higher prices than average as the amount has to involve a commission for the platform itself. Zimmer, a Quikr owned hyperlocal services startup, also works on this model.

Both of them have their advantages hence both work in different situations. Individuals who do not wish to delve into negotiations, verification etc would prefer the latter, while users who like to exert a certain degree of control over the services they go for will go after the former.

MONETISATION

There are different ways in which these platforms look at monetisation. For basic search and discovery platforms, Justdial for example, revenue streams in mainly through things like subscription and registration fees, and advertising. Since they depend on one way lead generation (showing the customer results based on their requirements), they can charge service providers to be listed higher on such search results. On the other hand, they can also charge customers a fixed amount to be able to avail their services, or for a higher tier of their services.

For transactional platforms like Housejoy, Urbanclap, Cheep and more, there are certain other streams of revenue available. At any given point, these platforms are aware of the request generated by the customer, as well as the specific services (and its details like pricing, what's included etc) being offered

by the provider. Hence they are able to close the loop on a complete transaction, knowing exactly which customer to match with which provider. This allows them to charge a commission from the provider to avail a job. Urbanclap follows the commission model where it has instant booking of services. The consumer buys the service and professional pays a commission amount to accept the booking, and the platform helps with the delivery and operations using its automated engines.

Additionally, reverse-bidding, available on platforms like Cheep, opens up additional revenue segments. For instance, a job gets listed in a locality. Any providers who have listed that locality as their service area will be able to see the job request, and bid on it. Now, contrary to what you may think, it's not the amount they bid for the service that matters to the platform here - that's between the user and the provider. Here, they instead pay a certain amount to be able to bid on the service - think of it as a buy-in of a kind - which is usually proportional to the standard value of the services requested.

Apart from the additional revenue methods, the transactional model offers greater control over service quality,

hence allowing greater monetisation opportunities for both the platform as well as the provider. Even with the initial training and equipment costs involved, appropriate assistance from the platforms can, and does, even offset that.

FUTURE OF THE SEGMENT - AGGREGATORS OF AGGREGATORS

It is abundantly clear that there is no distinct leader in India's hyperlocal services market. In such a situation, how does a customer choose between platforms for a particular service? How do they ensure that they are getting the most bang for their buck? QuikrServices has tried to answer that question in an interesting way. Instead of setting up

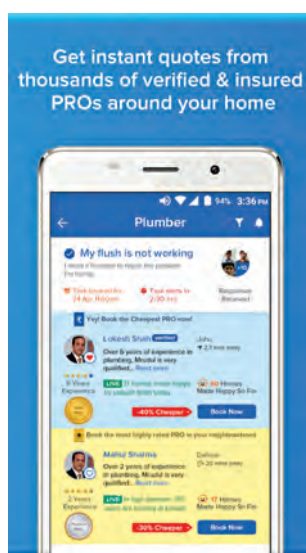


Google Areo is on the right track

their own network of services, they have established subsidiaries or partners across verticals and provide a curated list of services powered by these platforms on their

portfolio of services. This allows them to take advantage of networks already established in various cities and offer only those services that are readily available there. For instance, bike rentals in Mumbai are powered by RoyalBrothers, home services by AtHomeDiva etc. Beyond that, QuikrServices works on a reverse bidding process.

Taking this entire segment to the next level would require a more direct and head-on competition. For that, we need an aggregator of aggregators - a platform that lists every single service offered by the hyperlocal services startups in a comparative fashion, allowing the customer to make an informed decision. Something like this is being offered by Areo, an app from Google, but it will still take some time for the platform to mature and provide a comprehensive repository of services. This would not only enforce better pricing, but also provide an impetus to platforms to be upfront and transparent in their services. It's about time that benefits beyond convenience trickle down to us customers too. **d**



Cheep, one of the newest entrants in the segment, is from the same people who own TopsGrup, one of India's most trusted private security firms